How to Use Your STR Deal Analyzer

SKU ACQ-001 · STR DEAL ANALYZER

What this workbook does

Underwrites a single short-term rental property purchase. Plug in price, financing, projected revenue, and operating expenses — the workbook outputs cash-on-cash return, DSCR, cap rate, and a verdict (BUY / WALK / NEGOTIATE) on the Verdict tab.

Use this BEFORE you make an offer. Once a deal is locked, the workbook becomes your underwriting record for lender + CPA.

First-time setup (5 min)

1. Open tab **Property Inputs** — fill in the property address, purchase price, closing costs, and rehab budget.
2. Tab **Financing** — enter loan amount, rate, term, points. The workbook auto-computes monthly P+I.
3. Tab **Revenue Forecast** — pull comp data from AirDNA, Rabbu, or Mashvisor for the same zip code + bed count. Plug in projected ADR + occupancy. The workbook computes annual gross.
4. Tab **OpEx** — enter cleaning, utilities, insurance, property tax, management fee %, supplies, internet, software, repairs reserve. The workbook computes annual NOI.

Reading the outputs

- **Cash-on-cash return:** annual cash flow ÷ total cash invested. Anything 8%+ is solid for STR; 12%+ is exceptional.
- **DSCR (Debt Service Coverage Ratio):** NOI ÷ annual debt service. Lender minimum is typically 1.20–1.25. Below 1.0 means the property doesn't cover its own loan.
- **Cap rate:** NOI ÷ purchase price. Useful for comparing properties across markets.
- **Verdict tab:** auto-classifies the deal BUY / WALK / NEGOTIATE based on your thresholds (Settings tab).

When to walk

The Verdict tab fires WALK when DSCR < 1.20 OR cash-on-cash < 6%. Both can be addressed by negotiating price down or restructuring financing — but if neither is possible, walk. STR markets soften; over-leveraged properties don't survive.

At offer time

1. Print the Underwriting Summary tab to PDF. Send to your lender — most underwriters appreciate it.
2. Print the Verdict tab — that's your decision record.
3. If you submit an offer, save a copy of the workbook in your deal folder named `<address>-underwriting-<date>.xlsx`.

Questions?

hello@thestrledger.com — real humans, fast replies.

Upgrade path: The Full version on thestrledger.com adds stress-testing (bad-occupancy / bad-ADR scenarios) and the Y1-vs-stabilized toggle. The Acquisition Bundle pairs it with the Cost-to-Launch Calculator (ACQ-002) and 5-Year Pro Forma (ACQ-008).

How to Use Your Cost-to-Launch Calculator

SKU ACQ-002 · COST-TO-LAUNCH CALCULATOR

What this workbook does

Forecasts the total cash you need to take a residential property from "I just closed" to "first guest checks in." Closing costs, rehab, furnishings (120-item line-by-line), licensing, photography, listing setup, and the 90-day operating runway. Plus Y1 ROI projection so you know whether the launch dollars come back.

Use this BEFORE you wire your earnest money. Most STR launches go over budget by 30-50% because the buyer didn't have a line-by-line list — they had a guess.

First-time setup (10 min)

1. Open tab **Property Snapshot** — name, address, beds, baths, square footage, target opening date.
2. Tab **Closing Costs** — paste your loan estimate from the lender. The workbook breaks out the deductible vs capitalizable items.
3. Tab **Rehab + Repairs** — line items for any pre-launch fixes: paint, flooring, appliances, plumbing, electrical, exterior. Use your inspection report.
4. Tab **Furnishings (120-item)** — the heart of the workbook. Pre-loaded with a complete furnishing list: bedroom by bedroom, kitchen, bath, living, exterior, technology, supplies. Mark each item Buy / Already Have / Skip and enter cost.
5. Tab **Setup Costs** — STR license / TOT registration, professional photography, listing copy, software subscriptions (PriceLabs, Hostfully, AirDNA), insurance binder.
6. Tab **Operating Runway** — 90 days of fixed costs (mortgage, insurance, utilities, software) reserved against zero bookings.

Reading the outputs

- **Total Cash to Launch:** the sum of all 6 input tabs. This is the money that needs to be in your account at closing.
- **Y1 ROI:** Y1 net income ÷ total cash to launch. Anything 12%+ is solid; under 8% means reconsider the deal.
- **Furnishing density:** total furnishing $ ÷ square footage. Industry benchmark for 4-star STR: $25-35/sqft. Lower = under-furnished, higher = over-spent.

Categories to watch

- **Furnishings is where most launches blow the budget.** $5-15K is the realistic range for a 2-bed, 2-bath. The 120-item list catches everything (toaster, can opener, ice tray) that "I'll just grab one" turns into $3K of forgotten items.
- **90-day operating runway is non-negotiable.** STR launches take 60-120 days to ramp to stabilized occupancy. Without runway, you panic-list at low rates and tank your search ranking.

At launch

1. Print the Master Cost Summary tab to PDF. Save in your deal folder.
2. Use the Furnishings tab as your shopping list. Check items off as you buy them.
3. After launch, the Y1 Actual column lets you compare projected vs. actual. Use that delta to budget your next acquisition more accurately.

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Upgrade path: The Acquisition Bundle pairs this with the STR Deal Analyzer (ACQ-001), 5-Year Pro Forma (ACQ-008), and Furniture Setup Budget detailed tool (ACQ-007).

How to Use Your License / Permit / STR-Reg Tracker

SKU OPS-003 · LICENSE / PERMIT / STR-REG TRACKER

What this workbook does

Tracks every STR license, business license, sales tax permit, fire/safety inspection, and lottery/renewal date per property. Shows a countdown to the next deadline so you never lose your listing because a permit lapsed.

For multi-jurisdiction hosts (properties across several cities, counties, or states), this becomes essential — most STR-bans are enforced via permit-expiration audits. A $2,500 permit you forgot to renew can take your $48,000/yr listing offline.

First-time setup (15 min)

1. Open tab **Property Roster** — list every property with its full permit register: STR license, business license, sales/lodging tax registration, fire inspection certificate, occupancy permit, HOA approval (if applicable), any state-level lottery (e.g., Joshua Tree CA, Sedona AZ).
2. Tab **Permit Detail** — for each permit: issuing authority, license number, issue date, expiration date, renewal lead time, renewal cost, supporting document link.
3. Tab **Settings** — set your warning thresholds (e.g., 60 days before expiry → yellow flag; 30 days → red flag).

Every month

1. Open the Calendar tab. Yellow flags = renew this month. Red flags = renew this week.
2. Renew. Update issue + expiration dates. Document link.
3. The Penalty Reference tab shows what happens if you miss a deadline by jurisdiction (typically: fines $250-$5,000 + listing suspension until cured).

When acquiring a new property

1. Add it to the Roster on closing day.
2. Within 30 days, fill in the full permit register. Don't wait — most jurisdictions have 14-30 day registration windows after closing.
3. Set calendar alerts on your phone for the first three renewals (the workbook is the master record; phone alerts are the redundancy).

Multi-jurisdiction operators

If you're across 3+ jurisdictions, sort the Calendar tab by month to see the rolling year of renewals at a glance. Single-property hosts can ignore this view.

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Pair with: LGL-001 STR License Renewal Calendar (the calendar-only view of the same data), LGL-002 TOT Filing Calendar (sales/lodging tax filing dates — different cadence, often monthly/quarterly), TAX-002 Single-Property P&L (tax registration fees deduct on Line 17).

How to Use Your Break-Even Occupancy Calculator

SKU FIN-002 · BREAK-EVEN OCCUPANCY CALCULATOR

What this workbook does

Single-property break-even calculator. Computes: how empty can your property get before you're losing money? Also outputs the buffer-margin layer (10/20/30% above break-even) so you know your safety zone.

Most STR hosts memorize their "target occupancy" but don't know the actual break-even. When the market softens 15%, the answer matters fast.

First-time setup (5 min)

1. **Revenue Side:** ADR, cleaning fee charged to guest, avg LOS, available nights, platform commission %.
2. **Annual Fixed Costs:** mortgage interest, property tax, insurance, HOA, utilities, internet, software, marketing, +2 other lines.
3. **Per-Turnover Variable:** cleaning paid, supplies, maintenance reserve, other variable per turn.

Reading the outputs

- **Headline Answer:** "Property breaks even at 47% occupancy" (or whatever the math says)
- **Sensitivity Grid:** ADR × occupancy → net income. Find your tolerance band.
- **Buffer Margin:** at current 62% occupancy, you're 32% above break-even — safe.
- **10% Revenue Drop Stress:** simulates a soft market, shows where break-even moves to.

Common patterns

- Break-even <40% → strong cushion, safe in most market conditions
- Break-even 40-55% → typical for well-financed STRs; monitor seasonal dips
- Break-even >55% → tight; vulnerable to off-season cash crunch (use FIN-003 to forecast)

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Pair with: TAX-002 Single-Property P&L (input data source), FIN-003 12-Month Cash Flow Forecaster (forward-looking version), REV-002 Dynamic Pricing (lever to push above break-even).